

Sources and Accuracy Notes

Wyoming Coal, Peabody Retirees, and Cowboy Care

This companion guide identifies the published evidence behind the monologue. It separates verified facts, personal family experience, retiree recollections, and a policy proposal still being shaped by Wyoming voters.

THE PURPOSE	A source should help us test a claim, understand its limits, and continue the conversation. The links below lead directly to the original reporting or official material.
-------------	---

Claim-by-claim source map

Monologue claim	Evidence	Accuracy boundary
Powder River Basin operators used strong wages, healthcare, grievance procedures, and other benefits to sustain union-free mines.	The Washington Post, 1981 [1]	The article describes a regional strategy and focuses on operators including Amax and Carter. It does not prove a specific promise by Peabody or Black Thunder to an individual worker.
Peabody will terminate its Retiree Medical Allowance at the end of 2026.	Cowboy State Daily, July 27 and July 30, 2026 [2-3]	The reports quote Peabody saying the program is not aligned with market-competitive practices. Peabody did not state how many retirees are affected.
Retirees remember the allowance as part of the retirement package, including language suggesting it would last for life.	Gloria Buell's recollection in Cowboy State Daily [2-3]	This is a retiree's firsthand recollection. No publicly available written lifetime guarantee was located. Reporting says the plan reserved Peabody's power to terminate it.
One retiree expects to lose access to roughly \$240,000 in unused medical allowance funds.	Jim Allington's account in Cowboy State Daily [2]	The amount is specific to Allington and is based on figures he supplied: about \$260,000 expected and about \$20,000 used by year-end. It is not a per-retiree estimate.
Peabody reduced retiree healthcare benefits in 2020.	Wyoming Public Media, December 1, 2020 [4]	The 2020 action concerned healthcare for Medicare-eligible retirees and retiree life insurance. The report placed projected long-term savings at \$174.5 million.
A larger Wyoming purchasing pool can provide leverage, greater premium stability, and lower administrative costs.	Wyoming Employees' Group Insurance manual, 2025 [5]	The state manual documents these advantages for eligible public entities. It supports the pooling principle. It is not proof that every feature of Cowboy Care will produce the same result.
North Antelope Rochelle is a major Wyoming surface coal operation.	Peabody mine profile [6]	Peabody reports 65 million tons produced in 2025 and approximately 1,125 employees. These figures are company supplied.

Direct sources

Click any source title in the PDF to open the original page.

1. [Powder River Basin Mines Try to Best Unions at Benefits Game](#)

The Washington Post | Warren Brown | June 30, 1981

Documents comparable or better pay, medical and dental coverage, grievance procedures, employer-paid arbitration, and the explicit value operators placed on a union-free environment. The archive URL is dated July 1, while the article page displays June 30.

2. [Retired Peabody Energy Employees Feel Betrayed By Cancellation Of Medical Benefits](#)

Cowboy State Daily | Kate Meadows | July 27, 2026

Reports Peabody's 2026 termination decision, the company's stated rationale, Jim Allington's allowance figures, Gloria Buell's recollection, and the reported cancellation clause.

3. [Wyoming Congressional Delegation Silent On Peabody's Move To Cut Retirement Benefit](#)

Cowboy State Daily | Kate Meadows | July 30, 2026

Adds Keith Schaeffer's account, repeats the fine-print qualification, and reports that delegation offices had not responded to requests by publication. The URL is dated July 29, while the article page displays July 30.

4. [Peabody Ends Benefit Plan Amidst Financial Struggles](#)

Wyoming Public Media | Cooper McKim | December 1, 2020

Reports Peabody's earlier retiree healthcare and life-insurance reductions and the company's projected long-term savings.

5. [Wyoming State Employees' and Officials' Group Insurance Entity Opt-In Manual](#)

Wyoming Department of Administration and Information | 2025

Pages 3 and 6 describe the existing state pool, enrollment, purchasing leverage, premium stability, administrative-cost considerations, and tradeoffs. Page 20 explains the self-funded structure.

6. [North Antelope Rochelle Mine](#)

Peabody Energy | accessed August 11, 2026

Company profile for current production, reserve, employment, and rail figures. Used only for present-day mine context.

The policy conversation



Cowboy Care is a proposal in development.

Registered Wyoming voters can review the idea, answer the questions, share experience, and offer a better solution.

grassrootsmvt.org/surveys/cowboy-care

Accuracy note: Personal statements about Jimmy Skovgard's brother Joe and nephew Michael are presented as firsthand family experience. Published retiree statements describe each speaker's experience and recollection. They do not establish a universal benefit amount or a publicly available written guarantee. Cowboy Care remains a proposal for voter review, not a completed insurance plan.

Paid for by Skovgard for Senate